FINAL ISSUER REQUIREMENTS

University / Higher Education Institution

Required document 1: CHED Government/Institutional Recognition

Rationale
CHED Government or Institutional Recognition is the primary proof that a higher education institution (HEI) is authorized by the Philippine government to operate and to grant degrees and related academic qualifications. It confirms that the institution and/or its programs have passed CHED's evaluation and are listed as recognized HEIs and programs, which is essential for any credentials to be accepted for academic or professional purposes.

Required document 2: Legal personality document (SEC Certificate of Incorporation or charter law/ordinance)

Rationale
The SEC Certificate of Incorporation (for private HEIs) or the charter law/ordinance (for state universities and local universities/colleges) establishes the legal personality of the institution, including its official name and purpose. This ensures that the entity onboarding to ChainCert is the same legally recognized institution that CHED recognizes and that signs contracts and agreements.

Required document 3: Board resolution authorizing ChainCert participation and designating issuing officers

Rationale
A board resolution from the board of trustees, regents, or equivalent governing body documents the institution's formal decision to participate in ChainCert and to issue digital credentials. It also designates specific officers (e.g., registrar, dean, director) as authorized signatories, aligning with typical HEI governance practices and clarifying accountability for digital issuance.

Required document 4: Quality accreditation certificate (optional but recommended)

Rationale
Accreditation certificates issued by CHED-recognized accrediting agencies (such as PAASCU, PACUCOA, or AACCUP) provide evidence that the institution's internal quality assurance systems and programs meet established quality benchmarks. While not strictly required to operate, accreditation strengthens the perceived reliability of

credentials by demonstrating that the HEI voluntarily complies with higher standards of quality assurance.

References (APA style)

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https://philippineembassy-dc.org/verification-of-status-of-higher-education-institutions-and-their-programs/

Philippine Embassy in Seoul. (2025, December 22). *Advisory: Verification of higher education institutions*. Retrieved from

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Wise. (2025, November 18). *SEC business registration in the Philippines: Complete guide*. Retrieved from

https://wise.com/ph/blog/sec-business-registration

FilePino. (2025, April 14). *SEC registration: How to register a corporation in the Philippines*. Retrieved from

https://www.filepino.com/how-to-register-a-corporation-in-the-philippines/

Government Agency or Office

Required document 1: Legal creation instrument (Republic Act, Executive Order, Administrative Order, or local ordinance)

Rationale
Government agencies and offices derive their legal existence from formal instruments such as Republic Acts, Executive Orders, Administrative Orders, or local ordinances. Presenting this creation instrument confirms that the body is a legitimate government entity and not an informal or private group using a government-sounding name, which is critical for public trust in any credential they issue.

Required document 2: Mandate or function document

Rationale
The enabling law, administrative code, or agency charter that defines the agency's mandate provides evidence that issuing a particular type of credential (e.g., license, eligibility, training completion, regulatory certification) falls within the agency's legal powers. This ensures that credentials issued on ChainCert are not ultra vires (beyond the agency's authority) and remain defensible if questioned.

Required document 3: Office Order or Memorandum authorizing ChainCert and designating issuing unit/officers

Rationale
An Office Order or Memorandum is a standard administrative tool used to delegate functions and designate responsible officials. Requiring such a document for ChainCert participation ensures that the agency has explicitly assigned responsibility for digital credential issuance to a particular unit (e.g., HR, training division, licensing division) and named signatories, which supports traceability and accountability.

Required document 4: Sample official credential template

Rationale
A specimen or template of the existing government-issued credential (certificate, license, eligibility, etc.) shows the exact fields, wording and format currently used by the agency. This helps ChainCert model the digital credential structure closely on the official paper document, making it easier for relying parties to cross-check digital records against existing physical records.

References (APA style)

Respicio & Co. Law Firm. (2025, October 2). *How to verify if a Philippine government agency or department is legitimate*. Retrieved from

https://www.respicio.ph/commentaries/how-to-verify-if-a-philippine-government-agency-or-department-is-legitimate

Executive Order No. 122-C. (1987). *Creating the Office for* [example of agency creation by EO]. Retrieved from

https://elibrary.judiciary.gov.ph/thebookshelf/showdocs/5/7420

Training Provider / Private Education Provider

Required document 1: SEC Certificate of Incorporation or DTI Business Name Registration

Rationale
SEC registration (for corporations and partnerships) and DTI business name registration (for sole proprietors) establish the legal existence of the training provider and its right to use its business name. These documents are foundational for proving that the entity offering training programs and issuing credentials on ChainCert is a legitimate business, and they are often required before securing other permits and accreditations.

Required document 2: LGU business permit / Mayor's permit

Rationale
The business permit issued by the local government (city or municipality) confirms that the training provider is authorized to operate at a specific location and has complied with local regulatory requirements, such as zoning, fire safety, and local taxes. This adds a layer of assurance that the provider operates a physical site that can be inspected or visited if issues arise.

Required document 3: TESDA Certificate of Program Registration (CoPR) or equivalent program approval

Rationale
For TVET programs, TESDA's Unified TVET Program Registration and Accreditation

System (UTPRAS) requires program registration and issues a CoPR as the government's authority for a provider to offer a specific program. Requiring the CoPR (or equivalent approval for non-TESDA programs marketed as formal training) ensures that ChainCert only represents credentials for programs that have been formally reviewed and registered by a competent authority.

Required document 4: Program brief or training regulation alignment document

Rationale
A program brief that details the curriculum, learning outcomes, duration, and assessment methods—and, where applicable, shows alignment with TESDA Training Regulations—clarifies the basis for the credential being issued. This follows the same logic as TESDA's emphasis on curriculum, faculty, facilities, and alignment to Training Regulations during program registration and helps relying parties understand what competence or learning the credential represents.

References (APA style)
Technical Education and Skills Development Authority. (2013, April 30). *Program registration and accreditation (UTPRAS)*. Retrieved from

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TESDA Region XII. (2025, November 23). *Program registration and accreditation*. Retrieved from

https://sites.google.com/tesda.gov.ph/tesdaregion12/programs-and-services/program-registration-and-accreditation

TESDA Region V – Sorsogon. (2025, June 12). *Unified TVET Program Registration and Accreditation System*. Retrieved from

http://tesda5.com.ph/sorsogon/programs-and-services/

Wise. (2025, November 18). *SEC business registration in the Philippines: Complete guide*. Retrieved from

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Kittelson & Carpo. (2022, June 22). *Department of Trade and Industry – DTI registration in the Philippines*. Retrieved from

https://kittelsoncarpo.com/business-registration/government-agencies/dti/

Industry Certifier / Professional Certification Body

Required document 1: SEC registration or charter establishing the certification body

Rationale
SEC registration or a charter law confirms that the certification body is a legally constituted organization with defined purposes, which ideally include certification, assessment, or standard-setting activities. This is crucial to distinguish legitimate certification bodies from informal groups or marketing entities that may issue non-recognized credentials.

Required document 2: Evidence of industry or professional recognition

Rationale
Professional and industry credentials derive much of their value from acceptance by the relevant community. Evidence such as recognition by a national professional association, collaboration with a government regulator (e.g., PRC), or recognition by an international body helps validate that the certifier is acknowledged as an authority in its field and that its credentials are meaningful to employers and institutions.

Required document 3: Documented certification scheme or framework aligned with ISO/IEC 17024 principles

Rationale
ISO/IEC 17024, the international standard for bodies certifying persons, requires a documented certification scheme describing competence requirements, assessment mechanisms, recertification policies, and governance structures. Requiring such a documented scheme—aligned with ISO/IEC 17024 principles—ensures that the certifications issued through ChainCert are based on a transparent, consistent, and internationally recognized framework.

Required document 4: Board resolution approving the certification scheme and authorizing ChainCert issuance

Rationale
A board resolution that formally approves the certification scheme and authorizes the use of ChainCert provides governance-level endorsement of both the program and the digital issuance process. This clarifies that certification is not just an operational activity but an approved organizational function, and it identifies the officers responsible for managing credential issuance and maintaining scheme integrity.

References (APA style)
International Organization for Standardization. (2012). *ISO/IEC 17024:2012 – Conformity assessment – General requirements for bodies operating certification of persons*. Retrieved from

https://cdn.standards.iteh.ai/samples/52993/ddec6c8759214c5d958bf8f6d6d9ffaf/ISO-IEC-17024-2012.pdf

International Organization for Standardization. (n.d.). *How to develop schemes for the certification of persons*. Retrieved from

https://www.iso.org/iso/casco_-_certification_of_persons.pdf

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